The release of the hostages is an obvious goal for Israel. It is not clear what price will have to be paid for their release.

For the time being, no Arab country seems to be ready to side with Hamas, not even in words. To understand Abdel Fattah el-Sisi's abstention, one must remember that since Nasser's ill-fated belligerence and Anwar Sadat's initially successful war of October 1973, Egypt's policy toward the Jewish state has been decidedly peaceful. Sadat's role in this decisive departure from the policies of his predecessor cannot be stressed enough. It led to a peace agreement. Like Rabin a few years later, Sadat, in 1981, paid the price of his peace policy with his life. His successor, Hosni Mubarak, followed Sadat's policy from 1981 to 2011, when he was ousted during the Arab Spring upheavals.

It seems unlikely that the belligerent stance of the Muslim Brotherhood, briefly in power in Cairo from 2013 to 2014, echoed deeply among a growing Egyptian middle class that can only benefit from a policy geared to economic development rather than to Islamist militancy. In any case, as I pointed out, el-Sisi, who was appointed president in 2014, follows an extremely cautious policy in this respect.

Sunday, November 5

I was somewhat astonished by the highly positive response to the publication of my prewar diary in Germany some ten days ago. Now the real opinion of the country seems to be taking a different turn: there is probably no patience for talk of a two-state solution to the conflict between Israel and the Palestinians. And yet, whatever way you look at it, no other solution is realistic.

It so happens that today an interesting proposal was posted online. It was apparently written by a retired senior member of the Mossad. In a nutshell, his idea is that after the conclusion of the Gaza War, Jordan should become